

XU WANG

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EDUCATION

Peking University, HSBC Business School (PHBS)

Master of Finance

Aug 2024 – Present

Shenzhen, China

First-Class Scholarship; admitted through direct admission (top 10% of interviewees).

Coursework: Advanced Microeconomics, Advanced Macroeconomics, Advanced Econometrics.

Peking University, UK Campus

Exchange Program

Apr 2025 – Jun 2025

Oxford, UK

Shanghai University of Finance and Economics (SUFU)

B.A. in Economic Statistics

Sep 2020 – Jun 2024

Shanghai, China

Rank 1/107; GPA 3.76/4.00. National Scholarship; Shanghai Excellent Graduate. IELTS 7.0.

Coursework: Deep Learning, Machine Learning, Natural Language Processing, Multivariate Statistics, Econometrics.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Collusion in the Cards: AI Detection and Explanation with LLMs

Feb 2026 – Present

Advisor: Kan Xu, Arizona State University

Remote

Problem. Online card-game platforms must adjudicate collusion reports case by case: every move can be legal while coordinated intent surfaces only across the sequence. Labels come from 171 volunteer reviewers who disagree on 39% of 8,553 games, and an 84% positive prior makes accuracy uninformative.

Model. Designed VERA, a Qwen2.5-7B architecture that separates evidence from judgment: a rule-grounded analyst (rule-cloze SFT, then distillation on 501 teacher-annotated games) reconstructs each game from the log alone, while the player report bypasses it and enters a trained adjudicator. Proposed reviewer-aware weighted SFT: a cross-attention network over game, report and review embeddings, reviewer histories and vote structure learns a positive weight for each training case.

Results & contribution. On 500 test and 1,000 out-of-sample cases, VERA reaches 0.491 and 0.492 MCC, against 0.343 and 0.245 for a prompted frontier model and 0.424 and 0.420 for the best embedding classifier. Analysis helps only once the adjudicator is task-trained and hurts an untrained one; reviewer weighting gains most out of sample and needs no human review at inference.

Seeing and Hearing the Pitch: Multimodal Signals in IPO Roadshows and Underpricing

Jul 2026 – Present

Advisor: Kunpeng Zhang, University of Maryland and Yusen Xia, Georgia State University

Remote

Problem. Does how executives present in IPO roadshows, beyond the prospectus, carry information the market prices?

Model. Built a corpus of 600 STAR Market roadshows (599 firms, 18,560 sentences) with timestamped speech recognition, LDA topic segmentation, and sentence-aligned acoustic, facial, gesture and scene features; screened 749 features against 8 underpricing measures with time-based splits and global FDR control.

Results & contribution. The chairman's time share on technology and R&D content is the only presentation feature that survives global correction ($r = -0.16$, $q = 0.03$), with the same sign before and after the 2023 IPO tightening; dispersion of investor questions in the online Q&A raises out-of-sample R^2 from 0.091 to 0.128. Ongoing.

Conditional Random Fields for Sequential Consumer Choice

Mar 2024 – Jun 2024

Advisor: Xin Liu, SUFE SUFE Outstanding Graduation Thesis (top 2%)

Shanghai, China

Problem. Model students' sequential dining choices from objective behavior rather than self-reported satisfaction.

Model. Ran a 14-day panel of 60+ students (539 observations) and fit a linear-chain CRF conditioned on spending.

Results & contribution. 92.7% Acc; stationary distributions rank cafeterias by value and reveal takeout's rising share.

The Convergence of Equity and Efficiency: Evidence from ESG Disclosure Standards

Nov 2022 – Dec 2022

Third Prize (top 1.35%), 13th National Undergraduate Economics Annual Conference

Shanghai, China

Problem. How the GRI and SASB disclosure standards differ in design and in their economic effects on adopting firms.

Model. TF-IWF mining of 160+ standard documents; built a 3,711 firm-year panel from 4,062 ESG reports; DID.

Results & contribution. Contrasted GRI's stakeholder and SASB's financial focus and estimated adoption effects.

PRESENTATIONS (*Collusion in the Cards*)

- INFORMS 10th Workshop on Data Science, San Francisco Oct 2026
- INFORMS Conference on Information Systems and Technology (CIST), San Francisco Oct 2026
- Workshop on AI and the Future of Collaborative Innovation (WAICI), NYU Stern Oct 2026
- NC Analytics and AI Day, INFORMS North Carolina Chapter (poster) Sep 2026
- PHBS AIEM 2026, Peking University HSBC Business School 2026

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE & SKILLS

TikTok, ByteDance — Global Marketing Product & Technology

Sep 2025 – Jan 2026

Product Manager Intern (LLM applications)

Shenzhen, China

- Turned a vague “marketing intensity” judgment into an annotation taxonomy for undisclosed commercial videos; designed the prompts and, with the algorithm team, distilled a teacher LLM into a lightweight detector (90% precision at 70% recall; language coverage of global traffic from 50% to 99%).
- Built agent workflows for human appeal review, cutting review time from 48 to 2 hours and manual work by 60%.

Skills. Python, PyTorch, LLM fine-tuning (SFT, LoRA, weighted SFT), multi-GPU training (DDP, Slurm), R, SQL, LaTeX.

RESEARCH SUMMARY

I study how AI and human experts should share judgment in platform decisions: LLM pipelines that separate verifiable evidence from the final decision, and that learn from disagreeing reviewers instead of averaging them away. A second line measures what markets learn from how firms present themselves, using speech, text, faces and scenes. In a PhD, I aim to design and evaluate human–AI decision systems in business and information systems.

REFERENCES

Kunpeng Zhang, Associate Professor of Information Systems
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Yusen Xia, Distinguished Professor; Director, Institute for Insight
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